

Purchase Order Extractor

n8n setup guide

What you're setting up

Two n8n workflows that turn uploaded purchase-order PDFs into clean spreadsheet rows, and optionally into ready-to-integrate EDI 850 files. This guide covers importing them and connecting your own accounts. Follow the steps in order; the whole setup takes about ten minutes.

Before you start, have these ready:

- An n8n instance (Cloud or self-hosted, v1.6+).
- A free easybits Extractor account and API key – sign up at extractor.easybits.tech.
- A Google account with access to Google Sheets and Google Drive.
- The two workflow files: the main Purchase Order Extractor and the Generate: EDI 850 sub-workflow.

1 Import both workflows

In n8n, open the workflow menu and choose **Import from File**. Import the sub-workflow first, then the main workflow, so the main one can find it in the next steps.

Both import inactive and with no credentials attached – that is expected. You will connect your own below.

2 Connect the easybits Extractor

Open the **Extract: PO Data** node, create a new easybits Extractor credential, and paste your API key. Then point the node at a pipeline whose response structure returns the fields the workflow expects.

EXTRACTOR FIELDS – THE PIPELINE MUST RETURN

```
customer · supplier · currency · po_number · po_date · delivery_date ·  
articles[ article · unit · quantity · rate ]
```

Set `po_date` and `delivery_date` to return ISO format (YYYY-MM-DD). On the free plan, `currency` is the field to drop if you need to stay within the field limit – the workflow defaults it to AED.

3 Prepare the Google Sheet

Create a spreadsheet and put these headers in row 1, spelled exactly. Then open both the **Append: PO Rows to Sheet** and **Read: Existing POs** nodes, connect your Google Sheets credential, and select this spreadsheet and tab in each.

ROW 1 HEADERS – EXACT

```
Date | Customer | Supplier | LP0 No | Delivery Date | Items | Unit | Qty | Rate  
| Total | Document Name
```

The duplicate check reads the LP0 No column, so keep that header intact. Set the Append node's value mode to RAW.

4 Connect Google Drive (for EDI files)

Only needed if you want EDI 850 output. Open **Google Drive: Upload**, connect your Google Drive credential, and choose the folder where generated .edi files should be saved.

If you never switch EDI on, this node stays idle and can be left unconfigured.

5 Re-link the sub-workflow

Open the **Call Generate: EDI 850** node in the main workflow and, in the Workflow field, select your imported **Generate: EDI 850** sub-workflow from the list. Confirm the node is set to **run once for each item**.

This link cannot survive the export, so it is blank on import. The main workflow can't produce EDI files until it is repointed here.

6 Activate and test

Save and activate the main workflow, then open its form URL from the **On form submission** node. Upload one purchase order, leave the EDI toggle off for the first run, and confirm a row appears in your sheet and the completion screen reports success.

Then run a second test with the EDI toggle set to Yes and check the .edi file lands in your Drive folder. Upload the same PO twice to see the duplicate detection skip it.

Good to know

A few behaviours worth understanding once it is running.

- **The EDI 850 export is optional.** A toggle on the intake form decides, per submission, whether files are generated. Off by default.
- **Duplicates are detected by PO number.** Before writing, the workflow checks the sheet's LPO No column; a PO already there is skipped and reported on the completion page, not written twice.
- **Batch uploads are supported.** Drop several PDFs into one submission; each is processed and summarised individually.
- **Unit codes are standardised.** Free-text units (piece, roll, box) are mapped to X12 355 codes in the 850, so the file validates against strict trading partners.

Need to brand the form? The intake and completion pages accept custom CSS under each form node's Options, and the completion page uses a Show Text ending so it can render styled HTML. Match the accent to your own colour by editing the one accent value.

Extractor field map

Build these in the pipeline's response structure (Step 2). Add the six header fields at the top level, then add `articles` as an array of objects and nest the four line fields inside it. Use the exact names and types shown, and instruct every field to return `null` when the value is absent.

customer STRING

The buying company that issued the order (the hotel, resort, or retreat). Look under "MARK FOR", the invoice or delivery address, the letterhead, or a "FROM" section. This is the buyer, not the supplier or vendor. Return the company name. Return null if absent.

supplier STRING

The supplier or vendor company name. Look under the heading "SUPPLIER" or "VENDOR". Return the company name only; if a vendor account number is printed before it (for example "892 - PRIME INTERIORS FZ-LLC"), drop the number and keep the name. This is not the buyer or the "MARK FOR" company. Return null if absent.

currency STRING

The order currency as a three-letter ISO 4217 code (for example AED, USD). Use an explicit "Currency" field if present, converting a written name such as "UAE Dirhams" to its code (AED). If there is no currency label but amounts are prefixed with a code like "AED", use that. Return null if none is stated.

po_number STRING

The purchase order number, labelled "PO Number" or "Order Number". Return the identifier exactly as printed (for example PO26-009911 or PO-2026-8874112). Return null if absent.

po_date STRING

The purchase order date, labelled "PO Date", "Order Date", or "Order date". Ignore any time component (for example "09:15:00"). Output in ISO format YYYY-MM-DD. The printed format varies (day-first like 15.08.2026, or month-first like 05/12/2026); infer the correct order from context, such as a spelled-out date on the page or a value above 12. Return null if absent.

delivery_date STRING

The requested delivery or dispatch date, labelled "Delivery Date", "Date of delivery", or similar. Output in ISO format YYYY-MM-DD. The printed format varies between documents (17.07.2026 is day-first, while 05/15/2026 is month-first); infer the correct order from context, such as a value above 12 that can only be a day, or a spelled-out date elsewhere on the page. Return null if absent.

articles OBJECT · ARRAY

The line-item container. Mark it as an **array** with type **object** (shown as `object [ ]`) and leave its own description empty. Add the four fields below as nested fields inside it, one object per table row.

↳ article STRING

The product name or description for this line, from the "Article", "Item name", "Product Description", or "Description" column. Capture only the product itself. Do not include notes printed on the lines beneath it, such as a cost-centre tag in parentheses like "(01-IT Dept - UrbanStay)", a "PR Number:" line, an "Attributes:" line, or a "Line Comments:" line. These belong to the article above but are not part of its name. One value per numbered article row. Return null if the row has no description.

↳ quantity STRING

The ordered quantity for this line, from the "Quantity", "QTY", or "Qty" column. Return the number as printed, including decimals (for example 3.000 or 2.00). Do not confuse it with the unit price or the line total. One value per article row. Return null if absent.

↳ rate STRING

The price for a single unit, from the "Price", "Price per unit", or "Price P. Unit" column. This is the per-unit price, not the discount, the net amount, or the gross line total. It may carry a currency prefix (for example AED850.000); return it as printed. One value per article row. Return null if absent.

↳ unit STRING

The order unit for this line, from the "Unit", "Order unit", or "Purchase Unit" column (for example Box, Each, Roll, Pkt, Pail, Tin, piece). One value per article row. Return null if the row has no unit.

Field budget. As configured this is **11 fields**, one over the free plan's limit of 10. To run it on the free plan, drop currency – the workflow defaults it to AED, so the 850 file stays valid.

Need a hand?

If you run into any issues setting up or running the workflow, reach out to support@easybits.tech at any time – we're happy to help.